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Queen's Indian and Bogó-Indian for White

A 3.Nf3 move order that avoids the Nimzo while preserving principled central play

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

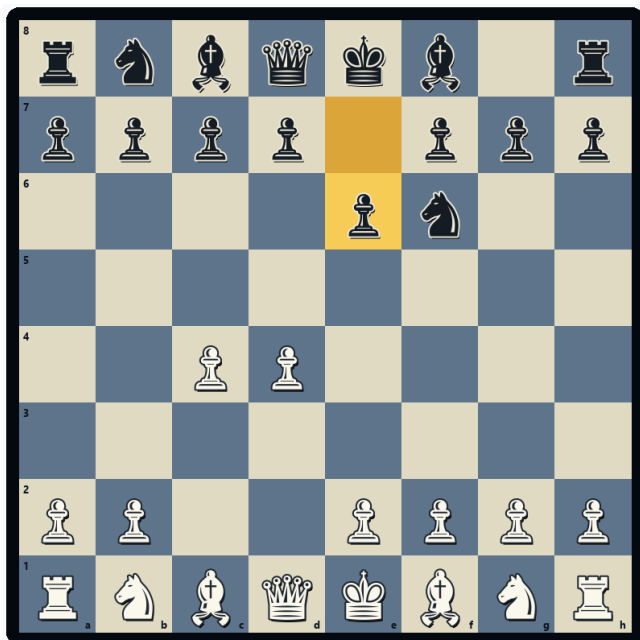
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

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01. Queen's Indian Core - Move Order



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Queen's Indian Core structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses g3, Nc3, or a3 to gain space and the bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian Core.

01. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian Core - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

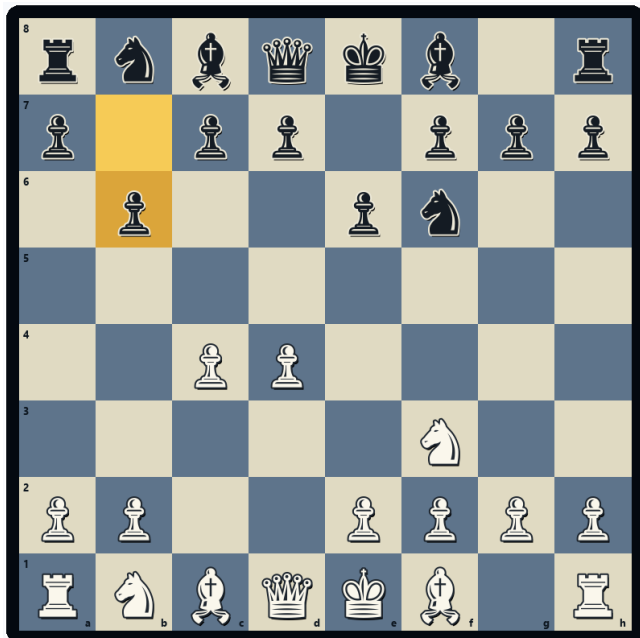
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian Core.

02. Queen's Indian Core



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Black controls e4 with pieces and prepares a queenside fianchetto.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses g3, Nc3, or a3 to gain space and the bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Develop the bishop according to White's setup and challenge the center with ...d5 or ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

The Queen's Indian restrains e4 first and chooses the pawn break second.

02. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian Core

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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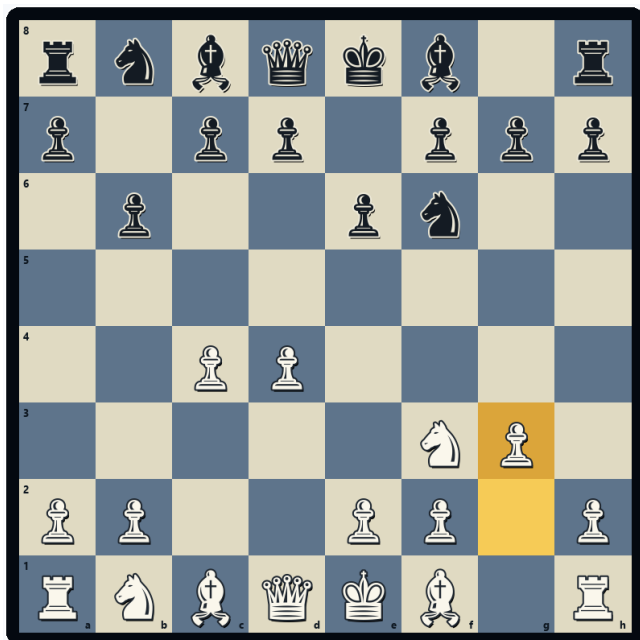
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Queen's Indian restrains e4 first and chooses the pawn break second.

03. Fianchetto with ...Ba6 - Move Order



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Fianchetto with ...Ba6 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White completes the fianchetto and seeks e4 or d5 space.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Fianchetto with ...Ba6.

03. Decision Framework

Fianchetto with ...Ba6 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

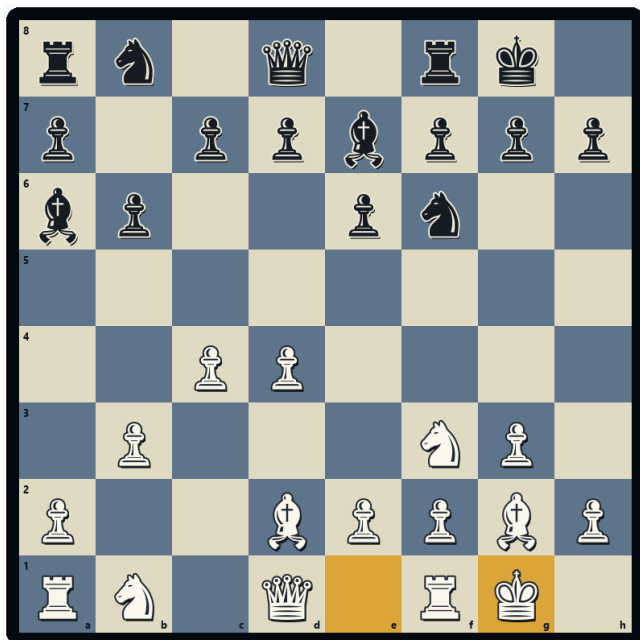
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Fianchetto with ...Ba6.

04. Fianchetto with ...Ba6



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Black develops outside the pawn chain and provokes queenside concessions.

PRIMARY PLAN

White completes the fianchetto and seeks e4 or d5 space.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Use the bishop to pressure c4 and complete development before choosing ...d5 or ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7 7. Bg2 O-O 8. O-O

MEMORY RULE

The ...Ba6 system is useful when it changes White's queenside development.

04. Decision Framework

Fianchetto with ...Ba6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

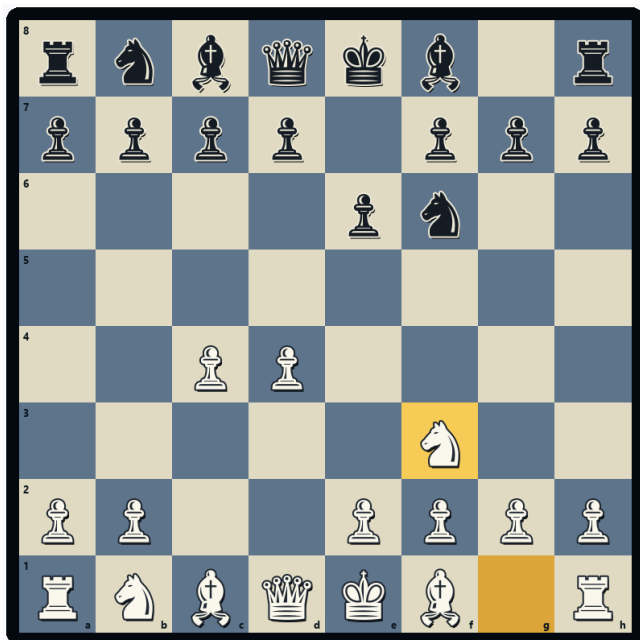
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The ...Ba6 system is useful when it changes White's queenside development.

05. Classical 4.Nc3 - Move Order



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Classical 4.Nc3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses d5 and e4 to restrict Black.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Nc3.

05. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Nc3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

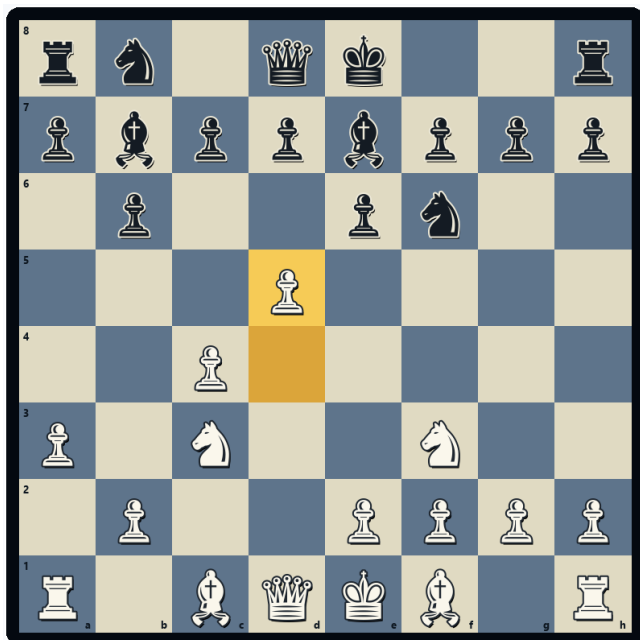
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Nc3.

06. Classical 4.Nc3



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

White gains central space while Black's bishop pressures the long diagonal.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses d5 and e4 to restrict Black.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Attack the center with ...exd5 or ...c5 and avoid passive piece placement.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. Nc3 Bb7 5. a3 Be7 6. d5

MEMORY RULE

A space advantage must be challenged before it fixes every piece's role.

06. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Nc3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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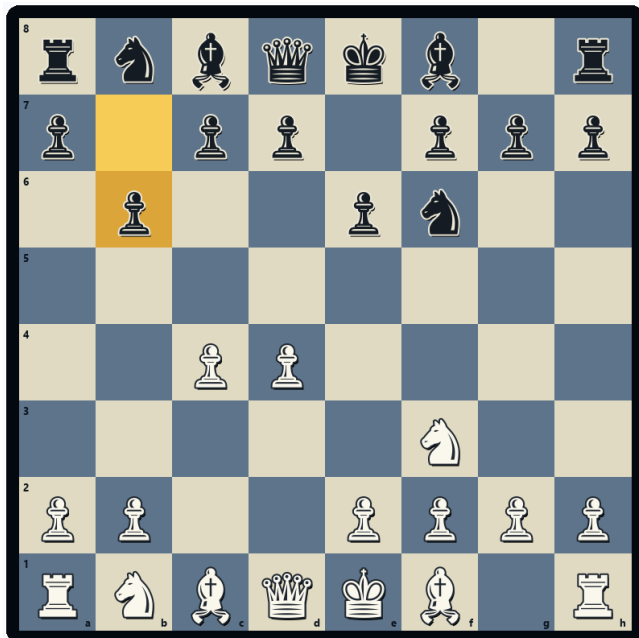
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A space advantage must be challenged before it fixes every piece's role.

07. Petrosian 4.a3 - Move Order



04 - Petrosian

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Petrosian 4.a3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White builds e4 and may use the Carlsbad structure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Petrosian 4.a3.

07. Decision Framework

Petrosian 4.a3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

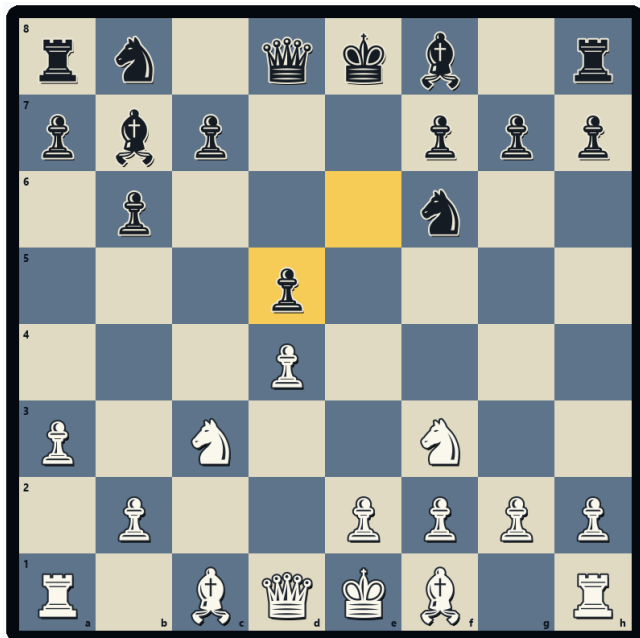
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Petrosian 4.a3.

08. Petrosian 4.a3



04 - Petrosian

READ THE POSITION

White prevents ...Bb4 and prepares a broad center without doubled-pawn concerns.

PRIMARY PLAN

White builds e4 and may use the Carlsbad structure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Use central activity and piece pressure because the bishop check is unavailable.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. a3 Bb7 5. Nc3 d5 6. cxd5 exd5

MEMORY RULE

When a3 removes one plan, redirect immediately toward the center.

08. Decision Framework

Petrosian 4.a3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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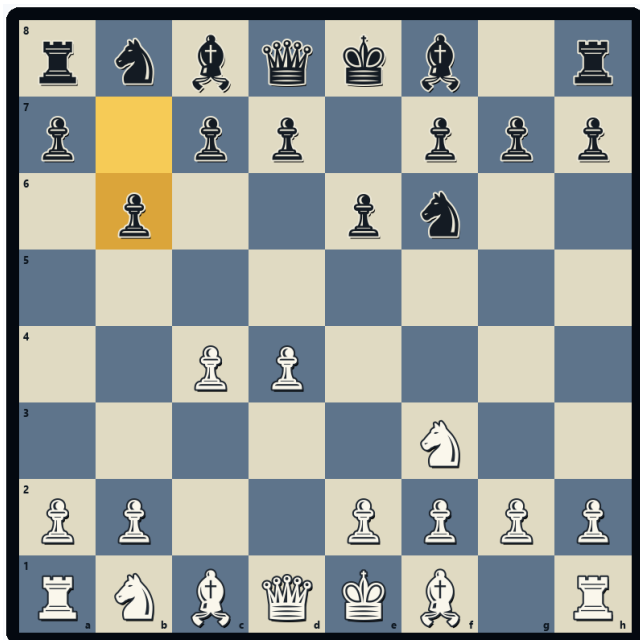
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When a3 removes one plan, redirect immediately toward the center.

09. Queen's Indian 4.e3 - Move Order



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Queen's Indian 4.e3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses b3, Bb2, and e4 for a broad center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian 4.e3.

09. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian 4.e3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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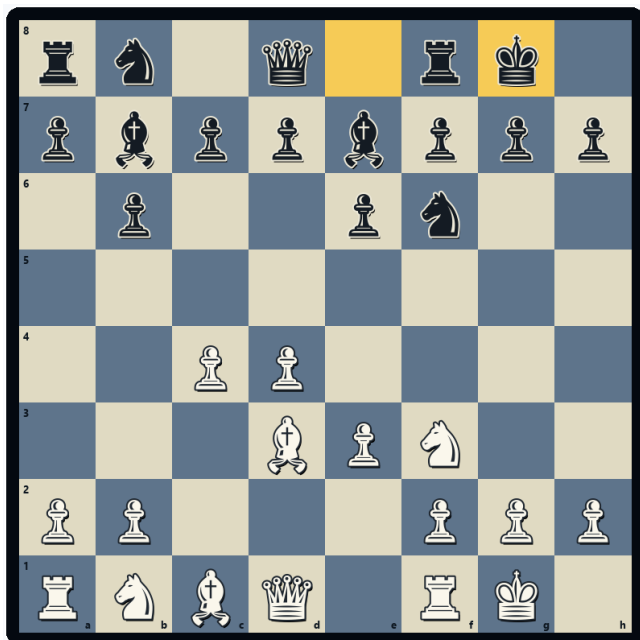
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian 4.e3.

10. Queen's Indian 4.e3



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

White develops quietly while preserving central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses b3, Bb2, and e4 for a broad center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete development and choose ...d5 or ...c5 before White gains e4 comfortably.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. e3 Bb7 5. Bd3 Be7 6. O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

Quiet development still contains a clock: challenge e4 before it arrives for free.

10. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian 4.e3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

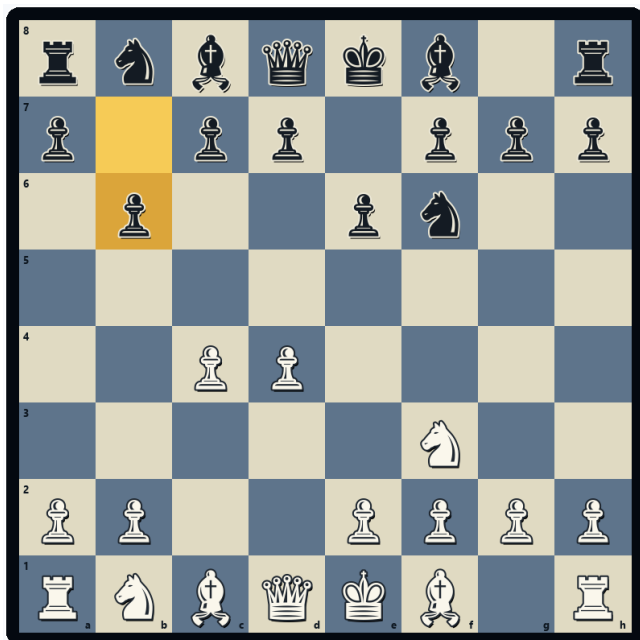
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Quiet development still contains a clock: challenge e4 before it arrives for free.

11. ...Ba6 and ...Qe7 - Move Order



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Reach the ...Ba6 and ...Qe7 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White may gain tempi with a3 and seek central expansion.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward ...Ba6 and ...Qe7.

11. Decision Framework

...Ba6 and ...Qe7 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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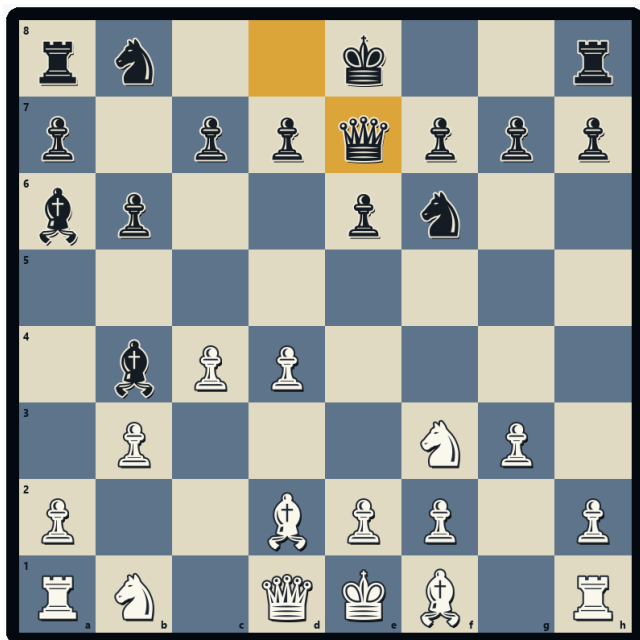
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward ...Ba6 and ...Qe7.

12. ...Ba6 and ...Qe7



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Black uses the queen to support the bishop and pressure c4.

PRIMARY PLAN

White may gain tempi with a3 and seek central expansion.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Finish development without exposing the queen and decide whether to exchange on d2.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Qe7

MEMORY RULE

Piece pressure works only when the queen does not become a target.

12. Decision Framework

...Ba6 and ...Qe7

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

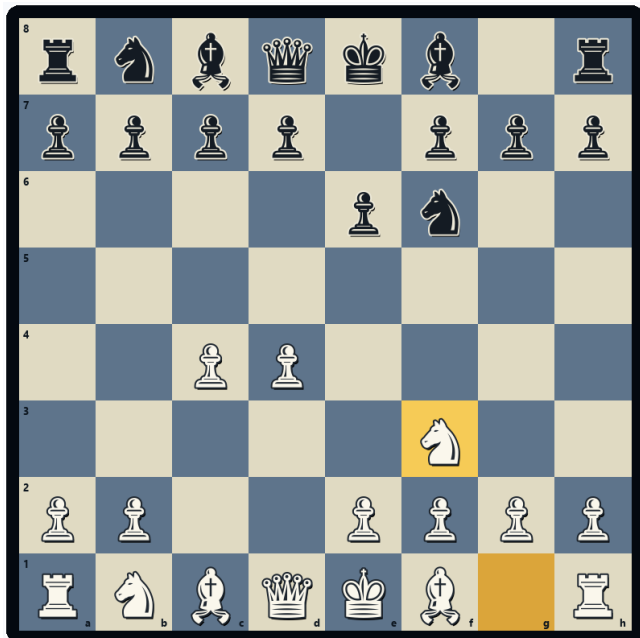
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Piece pressure works only when the queen does not become a target.

13. Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2 - Move Order



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2 structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Bxd2+, ...d5, or ...c5 to equalize before White gains the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2.

13. Decision Framework

Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

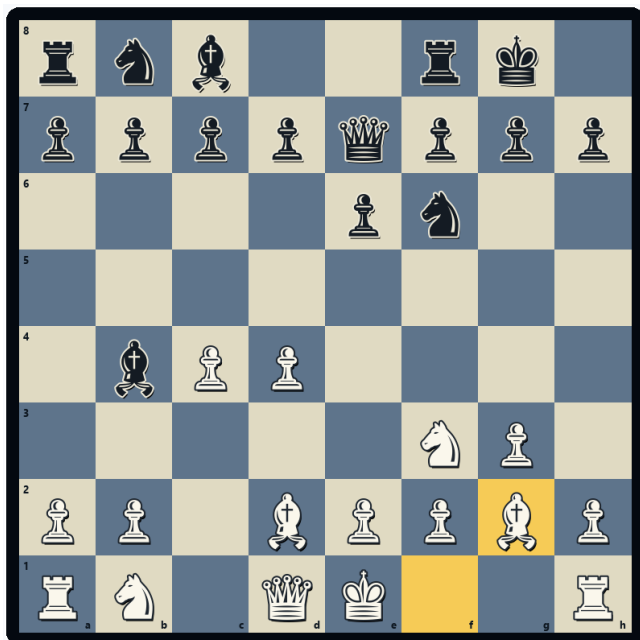
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2.

14. Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Black checks before White develops the queenside knight and keeps several central structures available.

PRIMARY PLAN

Meet the check without structural damage, complete the fianchetto, and prepare e4 or a queenside expansion.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Bxd2+, ...d5, or ...c5 to equalize before White gains the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Qe7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2

MEMORY RULE

Against the Bogo, solve the check and keep the center flexible.

14. Decision Framework

Bogo-Indian Core with 4.Bd2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

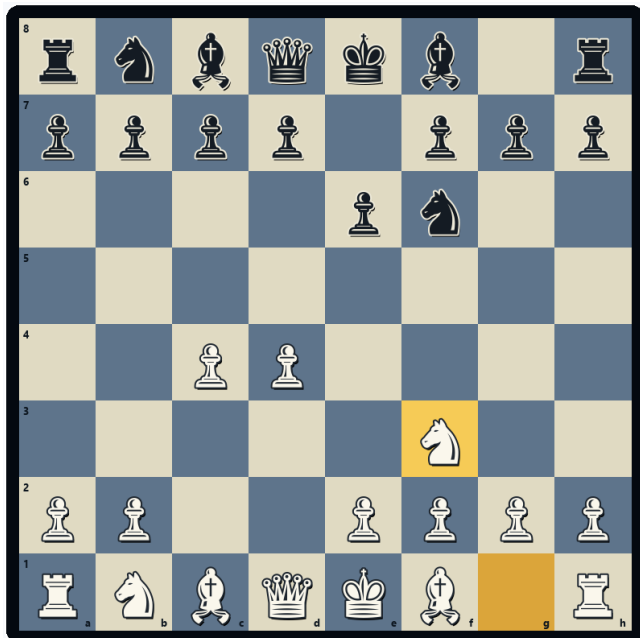
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Bogo, solve the check and keep the center flexible.

15. Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2 - Move Order



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2 structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black retreats, fianchettoes, and attacks e4 or d4 with ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2.

15. Decision Framework

Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

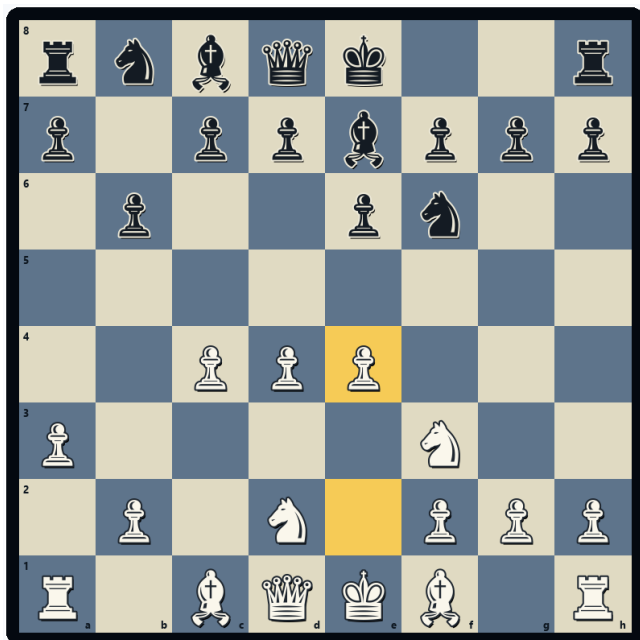
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2.

16. Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

White blocks with the knight and accepts a slightly awkward route in exchange for a broad center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e4 before Black completes ...Bb7 and challenge the dark squares with active development.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black retreats, fianchettoes, and attacks e4 or d4 with ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Nbd2 b6 5. a3 Be7 6. e4

MEMORY RULE

Nbd2 is justified when the center gained is worth the knight's slower route.

16. Decision Framework

Bogo-Indian 4.Nbd2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

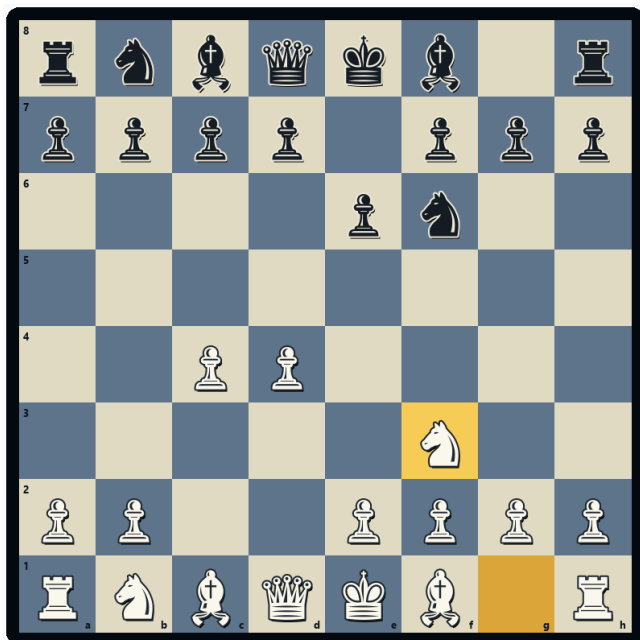
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Nbd2 is justified when the center gained is worth the knight's slower route.

17. Bogo Bishop Exchange - Move Order



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Bogo Bishop Exchange structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks easy development and a timely ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo Bishop Exchange.

17. Decision Framework

Bogo Bishop Exchange - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

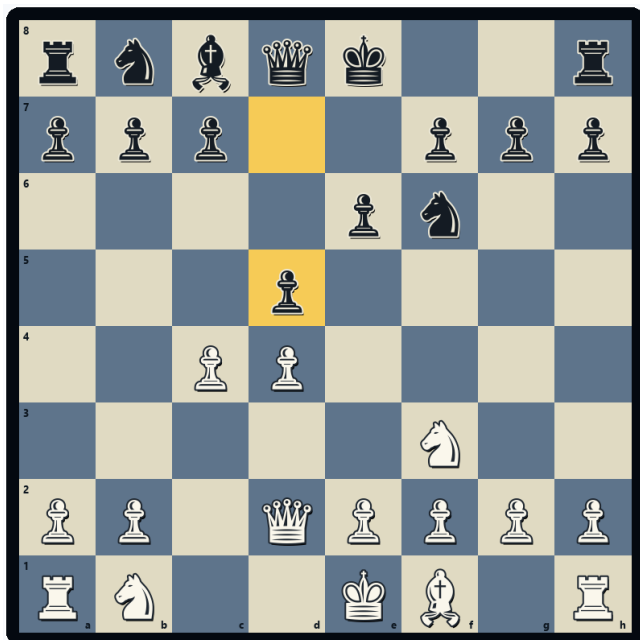
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo Bishop Exchange.

18. Bogo Bishop Exchange



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Black gives up the dark bishop to change White's queen placement and reach a solid center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the bishop pair and flexible queen to choose cxd5, Nc3, or g3 from the resulting structure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks easy development and a timely ...c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Bxd2+ 5. Qxd2 d5

MEMORY RULE

The bishop pair matters only if White opens the position without losing tempi.

18. Decision Framework

Bogo Bishop Exchange

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

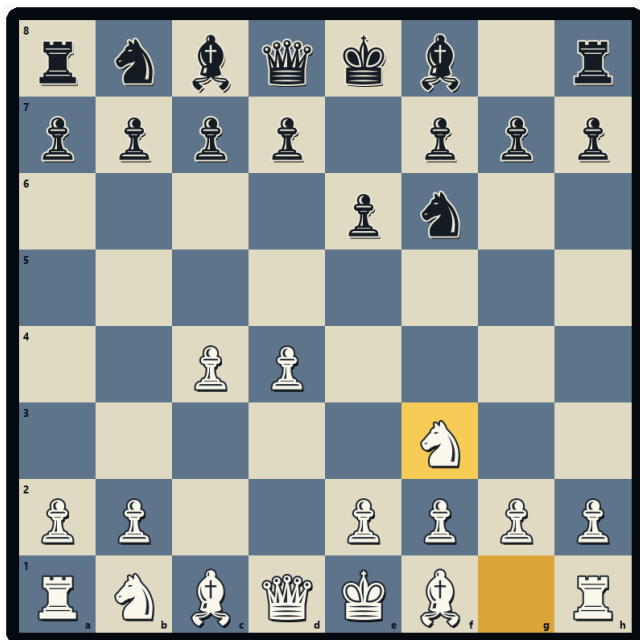
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The bishop pair matters only if White opens the position without losing tempi.

19. Bogo with ...Nc6 - Move Order



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Bogo with ...Nc6 structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...d6 and ...e5 or ...d5 to challenge White's center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo with ...Nc6.

19. Decision Framework

Bogo with ...Nc6 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

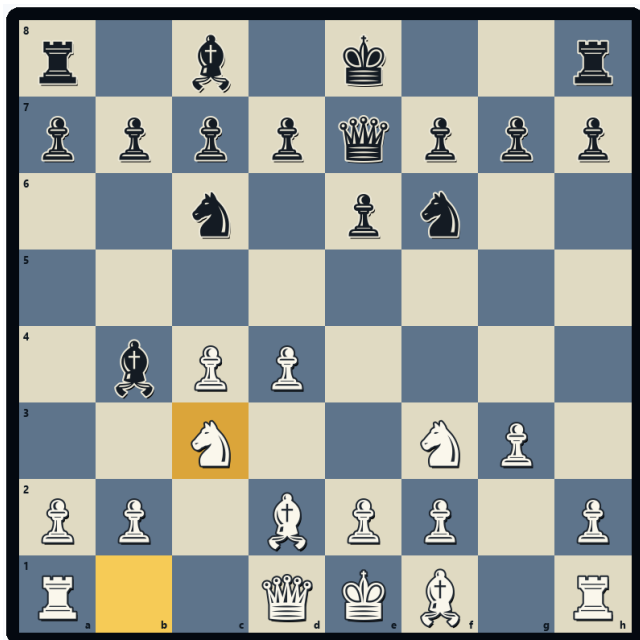
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Bogo with ...Nc6.

20. Bogo with ...Nc6



BOGO-INDIAN

READ THE POSITION

Black develops toward central pressure while keeping the checking bishop.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, watch ...e5, and choose a3 only when the bishop exchange improves the structure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...d6 and ...e5 or ...d5 to challenge White's center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Qe7 5. g3 Nc6 6. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Do not chase the bishop until the exchange creates a useful gain.

20. Decision Framework

Bogo with ...Nc6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Do not chase the bishop until the exchange creates a useful gain.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.